

EXCEPT / NOT Question Pack

34 Negative-Format Questions — Full Answer Key
Week 6 · Inspection (Observation) · Lecture 6

TCM for Ballroom Dancers

reMarkable Edition

How to use this pack: Negative-format questions ("All of the following EXCEPT...") are where students lose points even when they know the material — one wrong-in-context option hides among three correct ones. For each question, mark every option T (true/belongs) or F (false/doesn't belong) before picking your final answer — don't just scan for "the weird one."

EXCEPT / NOT Questions

1. All of the following are classical citations supporting Zang-Xiang theory EXCEPT:

- A. Huangdi Neijing — internal viscera must manifest externally
- B. Zhu Danxi — observe external manifestations to know what's inside
- C. Zhang Jiebin — zang-fu organs sit interiorly but manifest exteriorly
- D. Sun Simiao — the face reflects the five constitutional types

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

2. All of the following are among the Four Diagnostic Methods EXCEPT:

- A. Inspection
- B. Auscultation & Olfaction
- C. Inquiry
- D. Constitution Assessment

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

3. All of the following indicate Having Shen EXCEPT:

- A. Bright and moist complexion
- B. Alert eyes with a twinkle
- C. Clear speech, conscious, agile
- D. Dull, then suddenly bright eyes

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

4. All of the following are true of Red facial color EXCEPT:

- A. Entire face red indicates excess-type yang heat
- B. Malar (cheek) flush alone indicates yin-deficiency heat
- C. It is always accompanied by night sweats
- D. It can result from exogenous fever or zang-fu yang hyperactivity

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

5. All of the following indicate Yellow facial color EXCEPT:

- A. Bright orange = yang jaundice from damp-heat
- B. Smoky dark = yin jaundice from cold-damp
- C. Pale yellow, no brightness = qi and blood deficiency
- D. Deep yellow with bloodshot = kidney yang insufficiency

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

6. All of the following are Five Wheels of the Eye EXCEPT:

- A. Blood Wheel — canthus — Heart
- B. Qi Wheel — sclera — Lung
- C. Wind Wheel — iris — Liver
- D. Fire Wheel — pupil — Heart

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

7. Each of the following supports a diagnosis of Liver Yang rising with heat and damp EXCEPT:

- A. Bulging/protruding eyeballs
- B. Anger
- C. Red tongue with yellow greasy coating
- D. Weak voice and slight cough

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

8. All of the following eye colors indicate heat in some form EXCEPT:

- A. Bright yellow (tangerine-peel)
- B. Deep yellow + bloodshot
- C. White rings around iris
- D. Red, entire eye + headache

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

9. All of the following are correct organ associations for the Nose EXCEPT:

- A. Lung, via five-phase correspondence
- B. Spleen, via the Su Wen center-of-face map
- C. Spleen, via the Ling Shu bridge-of-nose map
- D. Kidney, via the five-phase correspondence

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

10. All of the following indicate a Cold pattern at the nose EXCEPT:

- A. Green/blue tip of the nose
- B. Clear watery discharge
- C. Thick yellow discharge
- D. White/pale tip (blood deficiency, related pattern)

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

11. Each of the following is one of the Three Yin Organs implicated in edema by location EXCEPT:

- A. Lung — edema starting upper body/head
- B. Kidney — edema starting lower body/feet
- C. Spleen — edema starting four limbs/torso
- D. San Jiao — edema starting in the chest

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

12. All of the following are true of the Ear EXCEPT:

- A. Kidney opens to the ear
- B. Long, full earlobes indicate a strong constitution
- C. High-pitch tinnitus indicates Kidney
- D. Purulent discharge ("Tin Er") indicates damp-heat of Liver & Gallbladder

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

13. All of the following ear colors/findings indicate their listed pattern correctly EXCEPT:

- A. White = cold
- B. Black = kidney failure
- C. Yellow = damp accumulation
- D. Red = deficiency

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

14. All of the following are true of Teeth diagnosis EXCEPT:

- A. Teeth reflect the Kidney (surplus of bone)
- B. White, moist, bright teeth indicate strong Kidney Qi
- C. Yellowing with age is a normal variable
- D. Deviated tooth growth indicates Liver Blood deficiency

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

15. All of the following are true of Gums EXCEPT:

- A. Gums reflect Spleen/Stomach (Flesh)
- B. Pale gums indicate blood deficiency
- C. Deep red + swelling indicates excess heat/stomach fire
- D. A blue line between teeth and gums indicates Kidney Yin deficiency

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

16. All of the following indicate Heat at the Lips/Mouth EXCEPT:

- A. Bright red lips — heat toxins
- B. Crimson lips — yin-deficiency heat
- C. Dry, red lips — heat damaging fluids
- D. Pale lips — blood deficiency

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

17. All of the following are true of the Throat & Tonsils EXCEPT:

- A. Deep red throat indicates heat
- B. Acute redness/swelling indicates wind invasion (exterior)
- C. Chronic dryness, NOT swollen/red, indicates Lung/Kidney Yin deficiency with empty heat
- D. Pale red throat always indicates excess heat

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

18. All of the following indicate Blood/Kidney essence sufficiency in Hair EXCEPT:

- A. Original color, shiny, lustrous, moist
- B. Thick, lustrous hair
- C. Premature graying
- D. Sufficient thickness without thinning

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

19. All of the following are true of Nails EXCEPT:

- A. Nails reflect the Liver
- B. Pink, normal luster indicates sufficient Qi
- C. Nail bed returning to color slowly after blanching indicates sufficient Qi and Blood
- D. Ridged nails indicate Kidney Yin deficiency or Liver Yang rising

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

20. All of the following are true of Skin findings EXCEPT:

- A. Too moist indicates Lung not controlling fluids
- B. Dry skin indicates Blood or fluid deficiency
- C. Dark skin with scales indicates Blood stasis
- D. Lustrous, harmonious color is an abnormal finding

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

21. All of the following are Skin Lesion types described in lecture EXCEPT:

- A. Papule — raised, red, seed-sized
- B. Macule — flat, red patch, color doesn't fade with pressure
- C. Blister — fluid-filled
- D. Wheal — raised, itchy hive that resolves within hours

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

22. Each of the following is a cause of a Yang-type carbuncle (Yong) EXCEPT:

- A. Internal accumulation of fire toxins
- B. Localized necrosis of the flesh
- C. Distinct border
- D. Insufficiency of Qi and Blood

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

23. All of the following correctly pair a secretions/excretions axis with its cold-pattern value EXCEPT:

- A. Color: white = cold
- B. Quantity: profuse = cold
- C. Quality: thin/clear/watery = cold
- D. Odor: strong = cold

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

24. All of the following are true of Infant Finger Venous Diagnosis EXCEPT:

- A. Used for children under 3 years old
- B. Left index finger is examined in boys
- C. Right index finger is examined in girls
- D. It remains a reliable diagnostic method into adulthood

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

25. All of the following gate-severity pairings are correct EXCEPT:

- A. Wind Gate only = mild illness/exterior pathogen
- B. Qi Gate = interior condition, stronger illness
- C. Life Gate = severe illness
- D. Beyond Life Gate to fingertip = mild, resolving illness

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

26. All of the following vein colors and their infant-diagnosis indications are correctly paired EXCEPT:

- A. Light red, not very visible = normal
- B. Bright red = heat
- C. Purple = stronger heat, creating stasis
- D. Green or dark blue = cold

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

27. All of the following are true of the Su Wen 32 Face Map EXCEPT:

- A. Forehead corresponds to Heart
- B. Nose corresponds to Spleen
- C. Chin corresponds to Kidney
- D. This map is identical to the Five Wheels of the Eye

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

28. All of the following facial diagnosis variable definitions are correct EXCEPT:

- A. Original/Host Color — the person's baseline color, fixed throughout life
- B. Guest/Visitor Color — temporary shifts following seasonal/climatic change
- C. Normal Variables — changes due to environment, light, emotion, activity
- D. Facial Sheen reflects Blood and Yin

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

29. All of the following describe Loss of Shen (shī shén) EXCEPT:

- A. Dim, dull complexion
- B. Dull, blurred vision
- C. Unconscious, delirious
- D. Suddenly responsive after being sluggish

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

30. All of the following are Deranged Shen presentations correctly matched EXCEPT:

- A. Fán zào — irritability, hot/feverish sensation
- B. Zàng zào — visceral agitation, crying spells
- C. Bái hé bìng — raving, obscenities, wandering naked
- D. Kuáng — yang madness, aggression

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

31. All of the following are true of Body Shape observations EXCEPT:

- A. Overweight + mental depression indicates Qi deficiency with phlegm-damp
- B. Thin person with dry skin indicates blood insufficiency
- C. Large barrel chest indicates full condition of lung/stomach
- D. Overweight thighs indicate Kidney Yin deficiency

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

32. All of the following are true of Movement & Posture EXCEPT:

- A. Active movement indicates Yang syndrome
- B. Passive manner indicates Yin syndrome
- C. Small, restless fidgeting indicates Excess Yang
- D. Tremors and convulsions indicate Wind

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

33. All of the following are true of Weak Constitution markers (Ling Shu 54) EXCEPT:

- A. Close-together eyes/nose/ears/mouth
- B. Short philtrum
- C. Long ears with long earlobes
- D. Flat, sunken, low, narrow jaw

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

34. All of the following are Five-Element body type physical descriptions correctly matched EXCEPT:

- A. Wood — greenish complexion, long face, tall, sinewy
- B. Fire — red complexion, curly/little hair, walks fast
- C. Earth — yellowish complexion, round face, big head
- D. Metal — dark complexion, big head, wrinkles

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

ANSWER KEY

#	Ans	Why
1	D	Sun Simiao is not one of the three cited sources for Zang-Xiang; this is a distractor pattern (constitution ≠ Zang-Xiang).
2	D	Constitution assessment is a separate topic; the four methods are Inspection, Auscultation & Olfaction, Inquiry, Palpation.
3	D	"Dull, then suddenly bright" describes False Shen, not Having Shen.
4	C	Night sweats accompany the deficiency-type (malar flush) presentation specifically, not red color in general.
5	D	Deep yellow + bloodshot indicates toxic heat, not kidney yang insufficiency (that's a Dark Grey/Black finding).
6	D	There is no "Fire Wheel." The pupil is the Water Wheel, mapped to Kidney, not Heart.
7	D	Weak voice and slight cough with sunken eyes indicate Lung deficiency, not Liver Yang rising.
8	C	White rings around the iris indicate turbid phlegm, not heat.
9	D	The nose's five-phase correspondence is Lung, not Kidney.
10	C	Thick yellow discharge indicates a Heat pattern.
11	D	San Jiao is involved in fluid metabolism generally but is NOT one of the three yin organs tested for edema starting-location logic.
12	C	High-pitch tinnitus indicates Liver, not Kidney. Low-pitch indicates Kidney.
13	D	Red ear color indicates excess heat (possibly damp-heat), not deficiency.
14	D	Deviated/missing tooth growth indicates insufficient Yangming Qi, not Liver Blood deficiency.
15	D	A blue line between teeth and gums indicates mercury poisoning, not Kidney Yin deficiency.
16	D	Pale lips indicate blood deficiency, a cold/deficiency pattern, not heat.
17	D	Pale red throat indicates empty (deficiency) heat, not excess heat.
18	C	Premature graying indicates depletion of Kidney essence, the opposite of sufficiency.
19	C	Slow return after blanching indicates EXHAUSTION of Qi and Blood, not sufficiency — immediate return indicates sufficiency.
20	D	A lustrous, harmonious complexion is the NORMAL finding, not abnormal.
21	D	"Wheal" was not one of the four lesion types covered (Papule, Macule, Blister, Nodule).
22	D	Insufficiency of Qi and Blood describes the Yin-type carbuncle (Ju), not the Yang-type (Yong).
23	D	Strong odor indicates Heat, not cold — no odor/faint odor indicates cold.
24	D	This technique is infant-only (age <3) and does not show reliably on adults.
25	D	Vein extending beyond the Life Gate to the fingertip indicates life-threatening illness, not mild/resolving.
26	D	Green or dark blue indicates Wind, not cold.
27	D	The Su Wen 32 face map is a distinct framework from the Five Wheels of the Eye — one maps face regions, the other maps eye sub-structures.
28	D	Facial Sheen is associated with Qi and Yang; Facial Color (not Sheen) is associated with Blood and Yin.
29	D	"Suddenly responsive" after decline describes False Shen, not Loss of Shen.
30	C	Bái hé bìng (Lily Disease) presents as chronic depression and sleepwalking — raving/obscenities/wandering naked describes Kuáng (Yang Madness).
31	D	Large, overweight thighs indicate Spleen not transforming/transporting, not Kidney Yin deficiency.
32	C	Small, restless fidgeting (e.g., leg bouncing) indicates Empty (deficiency) heat, not Excess Yang.
33	C	Long ears with long earlobes indicate a STRONG constitution, not weak.

